

Buyer committee map

Multi-stakeholder institutional deals (primarily Digital Cash, sometimes large Pay by Bank) close only when each committee role gets the right pitch. This document maps roles to priorities and to the pitch angle that lands with each.

Owner: Commercial · Confidential

IN SHORT

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When this framework applies

DIGITAL CASH

Always

Buying committee is wide by default.

PAY BY BANK

Often, at enterprise

GBP 100 million+ volume — Finance, Risk, Compliance and Engineering each hold a veto.

STABLECOIN FACTORY

Rarely

Own-programme deals: 2–4 technical decision-makers, not a formal committee. Partner-Led and White-Label motions can be wider.

The institutional buying committee — Digital Cash baseline

Each role weighs the decision differently. The pitch that lands with one misses with another, so the angle shifts with the person in the room.

EXECUTIVE SPONSOR

CFO, COO, Chief Digital Officer

Their priority: Strategic narrative, peer-positioning, board defensibility, multi-year commitment.

The opening question: *"Where does digital cash sit on your strategic roadmap? What's the board-level conversation?"*

What lands: Strategic positioning, anonymous peer comparisons, multi-year partnership model.

What misses: Technical detail, operational minutiae, vendor-spec-sheet pitch.

Veto power: Ultimate. Without an exec sponsor identified, the deal does not close — it stays a discussion forever.

HEAD OF TREASURY

Head of Treasury

Their priority: Liquidity, reserve management, FX, intraday settlement, capital efficiency.

The opening question: *"What does liquidity management look like for you today? Where are the friction points?"*

What lands: Treasury functionality, multi-currency, settlement-finality, integration with their TMS (Treasury Management System).

What misses: Web3 jargon, abstract market narrative.

Veto power: High — Treasury holds the operational P&L on settlement.

TRANSACTION BANKING

Head of Transaction Banking / Head of Payments

Their priority: Settlement model, cross-border efficiency, customer-facing impact, payment-rail strategy.

The opening question: *"How does your settlement architecture look today? Where's the cost-and-friction concentrated?"*

What lands: Settlement layer, on-ramp integration, interoperability, multi-rail strategy.

What misses: Stablecoin-as-asset framing.

COMPLIANCE · MLRO

Chief Compliance Officer / MLRO

Their priority: Regulatory framing, AML/KYC hooks, sanctions screening, audit trail, regulator-readiness.

The opening: *"Let me walk through the compliance architecture — issuer stays with you, controls hooks are built in. Any specific regulatory framework I should map against?"*

What lands: Issuer/operator clarity, compliance hooks, audit trail capabilities, MiCA alignment.

What misses: Speed-pitch and "easy compliance" framing — they will not believe it.

Veto power: Effectively unlimited. A compliance "no" ends the deal, regardless of executive enthusiasm.

GENERAL COUNSEL

General Counsel

Their priority: Legal structure, contract terms, indemnification, IP, dispute resolution.

The opening: *"Happy to walk through the legal model — Aryze as infrastructure provider, institution as issuer/operator. What contract framework does your team typically work with?"*

What lands: Legal architecture, contract structure, multi-year framework.

What misses: A sales pitch — they want clarity, not enthusiasm.

RISK · CRO

Risk Committee / Chief Risk Officer

Their priority: Failure modes, vendor risk, operational risk, regulatory risk.

The opening: *"Let me walk through the failure-mode architecture. The institution remains operator, so single-throat-to-choke risk is structurally lower."*

What lands: Architecture diagrams, vendor-due-diligence framework, exit/migration story.

What misses: Promises of "no risk" — they destroy credibility.

CIO / CTO

Their priority: Integration burden, tech stack fit, scalability, security.

The opening question: *"Walk me through your existing core banking, treasury, and ledger setup. Where does Digital Cash need to integrate?"*

What lands: Integration patterns, API documentation, security architecture, scalability roadmap.

What misses: Commercial framing before technical fit is confirmed.

How the map works

Before a workshop or multi-stakeholder meeting

Preparation runs in three steps: the committee roles in the room are identified; a 90-second pitch is drafted for each in their language from the matching block above; and the **Executive Sponsor** is identified. Without one, the meeting is about finding a sponsor, not selling.

During the meeting

With three or more committee roles present, the meeting is **a workshop, not a pitch**, and runs as a facilitation. Each role wants its priority addressed by name. Skipping treasury to talk to the CTO loses treasury's vote, and treasury has a veto.

Rule of thumb

When the committee role on the other side of a given question is unclear, one question resolves it: *"Help me understand — does this question come from the operational side or the risk/governance side? I want to make sure I give you the right level of detail."*

For Pay by Bank deals at large merchants (GBP 100 million+ volume), expect:

- **Payments Operations Lead** (primary) — operational fit, integration, exception handling
- **Head of Payments / Director of Payments** — rails strategy, vendor consolidation, roadmap
- **CFO / Finance Director** — cost savings in their language, predictability, EBITDA impact
- **COO / Payment Ops Director** — chargeback burden, dispute handling time, FTE load
- **Risk / Fraud Lead** — VAMP exposure, dispute exposure
- **CTO / Eng Lead** — integration burden, sandbox